drops of jupiter in her hair

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/52791196.

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General Audiences

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No Archive Warnings Apply

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Multi

Fandom:
She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

Relationships:
Bow/Glimmer (She-Ra), Adora/Catra (She-Ra)

Characters:
Glimmer (She-Ra), Bow (She-Ra), Adora (She-Ra), Catra (She-Ra), there's an OC but don't worry about that

Additional Tags:
Mutual Pining, Band Fic, Alternate Universe - College/University, Roommates, Hurt/Comfort, Grief/Mourning, Friends to Lovers, no one knows how to talk about their feelings so they have to sing about them

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by somebodysmuse

Summary

In the wake of her mother's death, Glimmer can barely bring herself to care about finishing college, passing her classes, or existing alongside her best friends, until Catra invites them to see her new garage band play. There, Glimmer meets a whole new set of distractions, much to the dismay of Bow, her long-time best friend.

TLDR: It's a band fic, Glimmer is avoiding her feelings, Bow is pining.

Notes

See the end of the work for notes

Chapter 1

Bow woke up to Glimmer crying, and even though he had woken up to the same sound so many times before, it still broke his heart.

"Hey," He said softly, gently shaking her shoulder. "Glimmer, come here."

"I'm so sorry," Glimmer sobbed, turning around. "Bow, I'm so sorry…"

"Shhhhhh," He said, holding out his arms. Still half-asleep, he pulled her closer, resting her in the circle of his arms. They had been through this countless times since her mom died- Glimmer went to sleep, telling herself that she was actually going to sleep though the night.

Until around two or three in the morning, when Bow would wake up to Glimmer crying or screaming herself awake, and he would hold her until she calmed down.

For the first few weeks after the funeral, she tried to sleep in her own bed just down the hall, but Bow heard her crying through the wall. Every night, he would go to her room and sleep beside her. Eventually, without either of them saying so out loud, they realized that Glimmer trying to sleep alone was futile, and Bow started going to sleep in Glimmer's bed.

"I'm sorry," She said, repeating her words from last night and the

night before. “I’m so sorry, Bow…”

“Don’t be sorry,” he murmured, gently stroking her back. “You’re alright, I’m here…”

Glimmer nodded her head and stopped trying to stifle her sobs, electing instead to weep freely into his chest, the same way she did every night.

“I miss her,” She whimpered.

“I know,” He said softly. “I do too.”

It had been less than two months since Glimmer’s mom had passed away. Despite what everyone at the funeral had told Glimmer, time had not eased her grief. If anything, it grew more and more every day.`

She barely remembered going to her classes. She barely remembered eating the food Bow or Adora put in front of her. She felt herself existing, but barely living.

She heard Bow’s breathing slow down, telling her that he had fallen back asleep. Despite everything, she felt herself smile. These moments, when she was wrapped up in her best friend’s arms, feeling the constant, reassuring beating of his heart, were the only times she felt almost alive.

OoO

Glimmer was either pretending to write, or trying to want to write. What was the point in turning in her final paper, anyway? She was sure that if she asked her professors, they would extend the deadline fo her. All of her professors were itching to do something for the poor girl who had lost her mom in October.

Besides, most of her final paper for Investigative Journalism 453 was all but finished, anyway. But her stupid cursor kept blinking after her final body paragraph, annoyingly beckoning her to write a conclusion, already.

Before she could attempt another word, Adora came down the stairs, dressed in an old lacrosse hoodie and her favorite leggings.

"Hey, you're up!" She said, not bothering to disguise the surprise in her voice. Glimmer knew she was remembering the weeks when she hadn't gotten out of bed at all, then the weeks afterwards when she slept until noon.

"I had to finish my paper," She said. "It's the last thing I have to do this semester."

"Oh, you lucky duck," Adora said. "All my finals are in person."

“Yes, but you’re majoring in physical education. Aren’t your finals like, pushups?”

Adora laughed. “Sit-ups this semester. Come running with me.”

Glimmer groaned. “I hate running. And it’s cold outside, we’re supposed to get snow tonight.”

“It’ll be a short run,” She promised. “Catra is coming over after rehearsal, so we need to be back in time to let her in.”

“Fine, fine,” Glimmer relented, standing and walking to Bow’s room. “Let me get changed.”

Adora’s long legs and athletic prowess had never made her an ideal running partner, but Glimmer always felt better when she came back home after running or walking with her. Today was no exception- when they returned from their run, pink-cheeked from the cold, Glimmer was ready to write her conclusion and finally turn in her paper. Before she could open her laptop again, Catra was knocking on their door.

“Hey, you,” She said, pecking Adora’s cheek before hanging up her cropped leather jacket. Glimmer hated that jacket. She was sure it didn’t keep Catra even a little bit warm.

“Hey, Sparkles,” She said, tapping the top of Glimmer’s head. “Come look.”

Catra strode to the middle of the living room, Adora trailing behind her.

“What do you think?” She asked. “New digs for the new crew.”

Glimmer studied Catra’s new shirt- it was a cropped red tee shirt with the word “Prime” written in black capital letters.

“Why ‘Prime’?” Glimmer asked. "Is it a math team?”

“No, professor, it's a band.” Catra said, rolling her eyes. Glimmer glared at Catra, but still felt grateful towards her. Catra was the only person who wasn’t handling her like glass after her mom’s death.

“Alright, I’ve got coffee for- oh, hi Catra!” Bow said as he walked into the apartment. “And Glimmer, good morning!” He could barely contain his delight when he saw her flushed cheeks and running shoes. “Did you go on a run with Adora?”

“I did,” Glimmer said. Maybe she should start running with Adora every damn day so it wouldn’t be such a *thing* when she did. “Tell us about Prime, Catra.”

“Well, we have a gig tonight, you should all come.”

“That sounds great, Catra, but-“

“We’ll be there,” Glimmer interrupted. “It’s almost the end of the semester, after all. Shouldn’t we celebrate?”

Adora and Bow shared a glance- for the last two months, Glimmer had barely wanted to go to the grocery store with them. Now she wanted to go to a club?

“Sure,” Bow finally said. “But I have a final tomorrow-“

“I do too,” Adora added. “So we might have to leave early. I’m sorry, honey.”

Catra pretended to sigh. “That’s fine, I suppose. What about you, Sparkles? Do you have finals?”

Glimmer looked back down at her laptop, her unfinished paper still mocking her. Without stopping to think, she saved the document and emailed it to her professor.

“Just submitted my last assignment,” She said. “I’m free as a bird.”

OOooOO

A few hours later, Glimmer, Bow, and Adora were crowded around a tiny table in a packed little club. Apparently Prime was attracting its fair share of spectators.

“This is impressive,” Bow told Adora over the music and the chatter of the audience. “Maybe they’ll get signed and Catra could do this professionally.”

Glimmer wasn’t sure what to make of Catra’s new bandmates- there was a particularly scary looking keyboard player whose jacket was even less functional than Catra’s, a drummer who looked more bored than anything, and then there was the lead guitarist.

He was tall and lanky, with pale blond hair that flopped around his head in messy waves. When he sang, he squinted his eyes like it hurt, or like he was impersonating Jeff Buckley. He didn’t sound like Jeff Buckley, but he sounded nice. The girl he sang with had long, lavender curls that she kept pushing out of her face. Glimmer wished that the guitarist would push his hair out of his face.

“Isn’t she great?” Adora asked, looking at Catra onstage with fond eyes.

“She’s wonderful,” Glimmer said. Catra was playing well, she seemed almost at ease onstage.

“What do you think, Bow?” Adora asked.

“Their songs are good,” He answered. “Do you know who writes them?”

“Their guitarist does, apparently.” Adora said. “The tall one who looks like he doesn’t go outside.”

“Did Catra mention his name?” Glimmer asked.

“I think JD?” Adora said. “Something like that.”

Before Glimmer could dissect why she was so interested in the guitarist’s name, the first set ended and Prime disbanded. It only took a few moments for Catra to find them in the crowd.

“You were amazing!” Adora said as Catra jumped into her waiting arms.

“You don’t have to sound so surprised,” Catra teased. “I mean- oh, God, what does he want?”

The guitarist was walking towards them. He had a little more color in his cheeks when he wasn’t under the lights of the stage.

“Do you have a pick guard I can borrow? I dropped mine,” He asked Catra. He was much taller up close.

“Sure, I’ll give it to you before we go on,” Catra said.

“So, these are your friends!” He said, turning towards Glimmer, Bow, and Adora. “Kitty has told me so much about you. I’m Jason Dean, but everyone calls me JD. Fewer syllables.”

“I’m Adora,” Adora said, holding out her free hand for him to shake. “And this is Bow, and Glimmer.”

“Hi,” Glimmer said, smiling almost nervously. Why was she nervous about smiling? “You sounded great.”

“You’re a doll,” JD said. “Are you staying for the second set?”

“Adora and Bow have class in the morning,” Glimmer explained.

“Well," He said. “If you want to stay, I’d be happy to take you back to the apartment when I take Kitty here home."

Catra rolled her eyes.

“That would be great!” She said. “If that's okay with you?”

“I- yeah, of course.” Bow said after realizing she was talking to him. She smiled.

“I’ll see you at home, okay?” She said. “Get some rest before your final.”

“I will,” Bow said, wondering why her well-wish felt like a dismissal. “Break a leg, Catra.”

“I will,” Catra said, giving Adora a goodbye-thanks-for-coming-I-love-you kiss. Glimmer waved at Bow as he left. He was wearing one of her scarves.

“So, you liked the set?” JD asked her, bringing her attention back up towards him. Catra had disappeared, she was probably off finding her least favorite guitar pick to let JD borrow.

“I did,” She said. “The hook in the one about the girl with stars in her hair was so pretty.”

“I wrote that one,” He said, flashing her a lazy smile. “Do you mind if I sit down? My back is killing me.”

“Not at all,” Glimmer said. They were almost the same height when he sat down. “Did you always know that you wanted to write music?”

“I did,” He said. “I used to listen to all these old records and spent hours figuring out certain riffs on my guitar, then I discovered electronic production, and the rest is kinda history, I guess.”

“That’s so cool,” Glimmer said, envying JD’s obvious passion for songwriting. She could barely bring herself to feel excited about anything, let alone passionate. Those feelings had been broken inside of her for months. “So, there’s a second set?”

“Yeah, we should be done around midnight,” JD explained.

“Midnight?” Glimmer asked, her eyes wide.

“Don’t act so surprised, Cinderella. Does your boyfriend normally not let you stay out so late?” He asked, raising an eyebrow.

“Oh, Bow’s not my boyfriend," She said. “He’s my best friend, we grew up together.”

“That’s adorable,” JD said. “Next door neighbors and everything? Took you to Prom and your parents took all kinds of pictures?”

Glimmer felt that familiar feeling in her chest, like someone had knocked the wind out of her. It happened, without fail, every time someone mentioned parents. Or moms. Or dads. Or families.

Glimmer didn't have a mom.

Glimmer didn't have a family.

“Uh, Glimmer? You good?”

Glimmer snapped back into the present.

“I’m fine," She said loudly over the pounding of her heart. “I’m fine, JD.”

“If you say so,” He said.

Glimmer kicked herself, she was hanging out with the cutest boy she had ever seen in real life, and all she could think about was her dead mom? Why did she have to ruin everything for herself?

"Do you want a drink?" He asked, apparently unbothered by her momentary lapse in ability to act like a human.

"I'd love a drink," She said, relieved. Glimmer didn't normally drink, especially not in public, but it would give her something to do, and would probably settle her nerves.

"Sit tight," He said. In a few minutes, he came back with a pink can.

"What is this?" She asked when he handed it to her.

"It's a seltzer," He said. "Strawberry lemonade flavored."

"Thank you," Glimmer said, opening the can and taking a cautious sip. It tasted like a vaguely carbonated, watered-down strawberry lemonade.

"I have to get backstage," He said. "Enjoy the set, okay?"

"Okay," Glimmer said, smiling.

“You,” He said, standing. “Have an excellent smile.”

He was gone before Glimmer could properly respond.

OoO

Glimmer was sleeping soundly beside him when Bow woke up the next morning. He breathed a sigh of relief, then noticed her claw clip was still holding her hair up. As carefully as he could, he removed it from her curls.

“Mmm,” She murmured, her eyes opening. “Morning? Already?”

“Just for me,” He said. “When did you get back last night?”

“Late,” She said, her eyes drifting shut again. “JD sang me one of his new songs.”

“Oh?” He said, pulling on his jacket. “How was it?”

“He sounds like Bon Iver.”

“Do you like Bon Iver?”

“Mmhmm,” She said, nuzzling against his pillow. “Goodnight, Bow.”

“Goodnight, Glimmer,” Bow said. He gathered his things and stepped out into the cold morning air. Who’s idea was it to have a final at 8 AM on a Friday, anyway?

Moreover, whose idea was it to have a gig on a Thursday night? Why on a school night? Even if they did sound like Bon Iver, who gave them the right to schedule their appearances so flippantly?

Woah, Bow, he thought to himself. *Take a deep breath*.

He supposed that there was nothing wrong with Bon Iver. Bon Iver made lovely music, and from what he could gather, was an entirely decent person. Besides, if Glimmer liked Bon Iver, she was allowed to like Bon Iver. It wasn’t Bow’s business, and it wasn’t like he had given her any reason to believe that liking Bon Iver would upset him.

Why did the fact that she liked Bon Iver upset him? How much did Glimmer even like Bon Iver? How could she even know that she liked him after knowing him for only a few hours in a dark, crowded room?

Bow rolled his eyes. He knew he wasn't upset about Bon Iver.

Bow had always been somewhat aware of his feelings for Glimmer since high school. He had known that he always wanted to have her around, no matter how old they were.

But then her mom passed away, and left Glimmer in complete and total disarray. The night of her funeral, the first time Glimmer screamed herself awake, Bow hadn't given it a second thought before running to her bedroom to comfort her. All he knew was that she was hurting and he needed to help her.

After he had calmed her down, he noticed that she was gripping the front of his shirt, her fingers closed into a tight fist.

"Stay with me?" She asked, her voice still thick with tears. Bow hugged her tighter.

"I'll stay with you," He said. He watched Glimmer's grip on his shirt front grow looser and looser as she fell asleep in his arms, and Bow realized-

No, no, he couldn't think like that. Glimmer was mourning the loss of the only parent she had ever known, and he had to be there for her in the purest, most selfless way he could. What would happen if he told her how he felt? What if she didn't feel the same way? Wouldn't that ruin everything between them? How could she hug him and cry to him and sleep beside him if she wasn't comfortable

with him? If she felt pressured to reciprocate feelings she didn't have the emotional availability for?

Someday, he would have to tell her. Someday when she was either strong enough to reject him or strong enough to give their love an honest chance. For now, he would be there for her, as steadfast as he had always been.

Besides, Bon Iver wasn't anything to worry about.

Chapter 2

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

I've been awake in every state line,

Dying to make it last us a lifetime.

Trying to shake that it's all on an incline,

Find me a way, I'll be yours in a landslide.

-Novo Amor, "State Lines"

A few days later, Glimmer was beginning her daily four-hour-nap when her phone vibrated.

JD: I recorded the new song this morning and wanted to send it over to you

JD: Since you liked it so much

JD: I liked playing it for you btw

She found herself smiling at her phone. JD liked playing his music for her.

GLIMMER: that’s sweet of you! I’m glad I get to hear it again before anyone else

JD: Exclusive content lol

GLIMMER: wow, I’m honored. I don’t think I’ve ever felt so special

JD: Maybe bc you are special?

JD: Idk I could be wrong here, buuuuut

Glimmer’s smile grew into a fully-fledged grin.

JD: There’s another club across town that asked us to come play, if you want to come and hear it live again

Was JD was inviting her to a show? Was it a “you can come if you want to and bring your friends so the audience looks fuller” invitation, or a “I want you to be there so I can look at you and flirt with you between sets” invitation?

Before she could get too in her head, she replied.

GLIMMER: ooh that sounds fun

GLIMMER: where and when?

JD: It’s tonight, let me text you the address.

Glimmer started to feel her nerves in her stomach- when was the last time she had felt anything in her stomach?

If JD’s gig was tonight, she should probably shower. Glimmer pushed her blankets off and walked to the bathroom.

OoO

It was 1 AM, and Glimmer still wasn’t home.

Catra had come back to their apartment an hour ago, saying that their gig had gone well, that the tiny space had been packed, and that Glimmer had been in attendance. This was their fourth show she had attended over the last two weeks. Bow had only gone with her to the first one. Despite the crowd, and despite Glimmer not saying anything, he felt like he was intruding on a private event.

“She said JD was going to drop her off after,” Catra explained, taking a long sip of the peppermint tea Bow had offered her. “I got a ride with Lila, who’s pissed at him.”

“I didn’t know JD and Glimmer were so close,” Adora said. “When did that happen?”

“I wouldn’t say they’re close,” Catra explained, her eyes flicking over to Bow. “And she said she would be home later, so...”

Bow sighed.

“JD is organizing a tour,” Catra finally said, like she had been waiting for an opportunity to announce it.

“I- what?” Adora said. “Like a concert tour? Like multiple venues and multiple cities?”

“How?” Bow asked. “When?”

“Soon,” Catra said. “It’s still in the beginning stages obviously, but Prime is getting more and more popular every day and people are asking about live shows, there are clubs and bars that host live musicians that are interested in hosting us, so...”

Bow’s gaze was suddenly very fixed on the countertop.

“It’s not official yet,” Catra said. “Obviously not, but it’s all JD talked about tonight.”

“Will you go with them?” Adora asked. “If it winds up happening.”

“I think so,” Catra said.

“Honey, I...” Adora sighed. “Of course, if you want to.” She took Catra’s hand and squeezed it. “We’ll talk about it more if it actually winds up happening, okay?”

Catra gave Adora a fond, relieved smile. “Okay.”

“So Glimmer knows,” Bow said, mostly to himself. “She knows that he- that you might be leaving soon?”

“She has to, JD won’t shut up about it.” Catra said, rolling her eyes.

“I’m beat,” Catra said. “Thanks for the tea, Bow.”

“No problem,” He said. “Goodnight, Adora. Goodnight Catra, sweet dreams.”

Catra and Adora bade him goodnight before leaving the kitchen, leaving Bow alone with his feelings.

In a few weeks, JD would be traveling with his band.

Bow hated himself for the relief he felt. He had no reason to feel joyous at JD’s imminent absence.

Bow hated himself for a lot of the things he felt.

OoO

“Wow,” Glimmer said as JD opened the door to his apartment, a little studio loft just a few blocks down from the club where their show had been. JD mentioned wanting to get away from his venues more quickly because people were starting to recognize him both inside and outside, so he suggested going to his apartment afterwards. “You have...so much music.”

She walked along the rows of records and CD’s, past the ones mounted on the wall next to his guitars.

“Thanks,” JD said, closing the door behind her. “I’ve been collecting since I was a kid, my parents took tangible music very seriously. I’m convinced my mom thinks streaming services are like, war crimes.”

Glimmer’s heart clenched at the word’s “my mom.” Glimmer’s mom had loved music, loved when Bow would practice his violin at their house, loved singing in the car with Glimmer-

“Do you collect records?” JD asked, putting his hand on the small of her back.

“No,” She said quickly.

“You should,” He told her. “The sound is much richer. This is how we’re supposed to listen to music, you know?”

“Sure,” Glimmer said. “I don’t even have a record player.”

“We need to remedy that immediately,” JD said.

“Well, what’s that on yours?” Glimmer asked.

“Uh- Rumors? I think?”

“I love Fleetwood Mac,” Glimmer said. Honestly, all she knew about Fleetwood Mac was Landslide and Go Your Own Way and the “you will never get away from the sound of a woman that loves you” part of Silver Springs, but she wasn’t going to tell JD that.

“I do too, Lindsey Buckingham is a machine. Legendary guitarist. Here, I’ll play you something.”

JD took a guitar off of its wall mount and sat on the floor in front of the sofa. Glimmer sat in front of him, watching his hands form a chord.

“That’s beautiful,” She said. JD flashed her a smile.

“Do you sing at all?” He asked.

“I- yeah, a little, but not particularly well. I did like, choir in high school.”

“Sing with me,” He told her. “I want to hear you.”

Glimmer rolled her eyes- did she even remember the lyrics?

“Tell me why everything turned around,” JD said, like he was reading her mind.

Hearing her own voice echoing around the high ceilings of JD’s chic apartment made her feel odd, like she was standing outside of herself instead of buried inside.

JD’s hands stopped moving.

“That,” He said. “Was beautiful, Glimmer.”

Glimmer laughed out loud.

“What?” He asked. “What’s funny?”

“You!” She laughed. “You- you’re so cool, JD.”

“I- thank you?” He said, laughing with her. “What?”

“I mean, you have a thousand records and play with a band and take guitars off of the wall like it’s nothing? You’re so cool, JD.”

A little patch of red appeared on JD's magnolia-colored cheeks, and he shook his head.

"You're cool, Glimmer," He said, then reached out to brush a pink curl out of her face. Glimmer stopped laughing and looked up at him with wide, expectant eyes. JD's hand moved down from her face down to her arm. He pulled her towards him.

OoO

Bow pushed his laptop away. He was trying to compose an email to one of his professors (future professors, since the semester didn't start for another week), but he couldn't bring himself to focus.

It was two in the morning. Waiting up for Glimmer was starting to feel less friendly and more pathetic.

Less friendly and more pathetic described his feelings throughout most of Winter break, actually. Glimmer had spent the last month wherever JD was, at a club or a bar or a bookstore...

What did they talk about? Did he make her laugh? When she was with him, did she feel safe?

Jealousy was an ugly feeling. He should be happy for Glimmer for finding someone that made her happy.

What was she feeling when she was away with JD? Did he make her feel happy? Or did he just make her feel less sad?

And how could he ask Glimmer about it without sounding like the green-eyed monster he was?

He sighed and stood up.

For the first time in months, Bow went to sleep in his own bed.

OoO

"JD?"

"Yes, Glimmer?"

"Why wasn't Lila there last night?"

"Things...aren't awesome with Lila right now."

"Oh, I'm so sorry."

“Don’t be, it’s creative differences, you know? John Lennon left The Beatles, Lila...”

“I understand.”

“Glimmer?”

“Yes, JD?”

“I have a question for you...”

OoO

When Bow came back to the apartment after checking the mail, Glimmer was sitting at the kitchen table with her laptop.

“Hi, you,” He said. “What are you up to?”

“Just emailing Casta,” Glimmer said. “We haven’t talked a whole lot since Christmas, and I want to keep her updated.”

“Right, right,” Bow said. Glimmer kept typing.

“Have you registered for your classes yet?” He asked. “They start in a few days, you know.”

“I know,” She said smoothly, closing her laptop and standing. “But- uh...Bow, I have exciting news, actually.”

“What’s going on?” Bow asked, his tone indicating that he was not even a little excited about her news.

“You don’t have to worry about me registering for classes next semester.”

“Why not?”

“I’m not going back to school.” She said.

“What?” Bow asked. “Why not?"

“Because Lila quit the band," She said, like that explained everything.

“What does that have to do with you quitting school?” He asked. “Glimmer, come on, don’t you want your degree?”

“JD asked me to take Lila's place,” She said. “We'd basically be splitting lead vocals, and hopefully, when we're done with the tour, a record label will want to sign us officially.”

Bow watched her for a long moment.

“Don’t look at me like that,” She said, crossing her arms. “Don’t you think our music is good?”

“That’s not the point, Glimmer," He said.

"So what's the issue?" She asked.

“The issue is that you're dropping out of school and going off with some stranger-“

“I’ve known JD for a month,” Glimmer said loudly. “And Catra will be there. Adora is totally on board with me going, by the way.”

Bow doubted that Adora was “totally on board with Glimmer going,” but he decided to ignore that for now.

“Where will you stay?”

“In hotels,” She said, like it was obvious. “Where everyone else is staying. And JD and I talked about it, we’ll stay together-“

Bow’s stomach turned.

“So it’s going to be fine," She said. “Why are you so against this?"

“I never said I was against it,” He reminded her. “But you're not giving me many reasons to be for it."

“Why not, Bow?”

“Because- I don’t know, Glimmer, can’t you see how this could be dangerous?”

“No!” She snapped. "I don’t! Why aren’t you worried about Catra's safety?”

“Because..."

Bow bit his tongue before he could say “because you’re fragile right now,” even though it was 100% true. Glimmer would never forgive him if she knew that he knew how distraught she still was after her mom's death.

And she absolutely wouldn’t forgive him for using it against her.

“I just…don’t think it’s a good idea for you right now, Glimmer.” He said as evenly as he could manage. “I really think that if you just gave it a little thought-“

“I’ve given it plenty of thought!” Glimmer interrupted. She looked like she did when they used to fight, when it got to the point where it didn’t matter why they were fighting, it just mattered that she was mad. “I want to do this, Bow. I want to *leave.”*

If Bow didn't know better, he would have sworn he heard her voice break.

“I want to support you, Glimmer,” He said. “But I can't tell you that this is a good idea.”

“I don't care about school,” She said. “I don’t care about finishing my degree, I don’t-“

“Then don't stay for school, Glimmer!" He said. "Don't think about school at all, that’s not what matters!”

“Give me a reason to stay then, Bow.” She said, her hands on her hips.

Bow took a deep breath, looking at this girl he had known all his life. There were so many things he wanted to say to her, things he had been holding close to his chest since before her mom died. Things he was afraid to tell her because it could mean losing her permanently.

Bow wanted, more than anything in the world, to take her face in his hands and kiss her, and let that be reason enough for her to stay.

But Bow sighed.

“If it’s really something you think you need to do, then I won’t stop you,” he said, resigned.

Glimmer’s expression changed from angry to disappointed, like she had given him a test that he failed.

“Fine," She said. “I’ll go pack, then.”

Bow watched her go.

Bow watched her leave.

Chapter End Notes

WOW HI GUYS HOW ARE WE

So I am a Novo Amor stan, and State Lines is part of my drops of Jupiter in her hair playlist, including many, many other bangers.

Glimmer is a singer in every fic I write. Figures.

ANYWAY, as always, please leave comments and kudos if you feel so moved. I love writing for y'all.

Love and some verses,
Somebody's Muse

Chapter 3

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Bow pulled his jacket off and draped it over the back of a kitchen chair. The first week of classes featured a blizzard, one that left six inches of snow on the frozen ground. The walk to campus had been brutal.

Which was almost a relief, it took his mind off of everything else he was feeling. Glimmer had been gone for ten days, and the void in the apartment was still gaping open, like a wound left to fester. Catra came to the apartment to say goodbye. Glimmer hadn't.

Occasionally, he would receive notifications from Glimmer's Instagram telling him where Prime was performing. They were performing back-to-back gigs in the Crimson Waste this weekend.

Bow glanced down the hallway at Glimmer's old bedroom, her door hanging ajar. There wasn't any evidence that Glimmer had been there, had ever lived just down the hall from him. No evidence that she used to sleep in his arms. Before he knew what was happening, he was standing in the doorway.

Was it normal to feel so broken up over one of his roommates moving out?

Glimmer wasn't just his roommate, though. Glimmer was the most important person in his world, his best friend for most of his life.

He took a deep breath- the room still smelled like Glimmer, like vanilla perfume and cinnamon gum and an assortment of scented candles.

Throughout the semester, Bow would return to Glimmer's doorway, waiting for nothing. Eventually, the scent of her faded away and the room smelled like nothing. She was gone yet again.

By the time Spring break rolled around, Bow was firmly entrenched in his routine of classes, research studies, and the elementary archery classes he taught at the rec.

About a week after his 22nd birthday, he came home to a visitor sitting at his kitchen table with Adora.

"Catra!" Bow said. Without thinking, he pulled her into his arms. "It's so good to see you!"

"Uh- hi. You too, Bow." She said, noncommittally returning his hug. "What's up?"

"What's up with you?" He asked. "How was the tour? I didn't think you would be back until the Summer!"

Catra shared a look with Adora and flopped back down onto the sofa. “I thought the same thing, Bow.”

“What happened?” Bow asked.

“I left,” Catra said. “JD isn’t just an arrogant moron, he’s also the biggest douche I’ve ever met, and he got much worse when more people started caring about our- his- shows.”

Adora smoothed Catra’s ponytail while Bow finally built up the courage to ask.

“How’s Glimmer?” he asked, trying to sound casual. Catra just looked at him for a moment.

“She’s taking care of herself,” Catra said carefully, an almost gentle edge to her voice.

Bow nodded his head, not knowing what he expected to hear. Knowing how Glimmer was doing didn’t make him feel better, but after three months, he wasn’t sure what would have made him feel better. If Glimmer walked in that door right now, holding her suitcases and ready to move back into his life, he probably wouldn’t have felt better. It wouldn’t have changed the truth.

The fact of the matter was that she had chosen to leave. She had chosen JD and the band and leaving.

He wondered, if he had told her how he felt, if he had somehow managed to muster up enough courage to tell her that he loved her, would that have changed anything? Would she have run towards him instead of away?

“Bow, are you alright?” Adora asked.

“Yeah, I’m fine,” He said. Neither Adora nor Catra looked convinced. “I’m...I think I’ll go to bed.”

“Okay,” Adora said. “Goodnight, Bow.”

“Sweet dreams- it’s good to have you back, Catra.”

OoO

The end of the semester came in a flurry of final projects and exams before summer fully settled in.

“There’s a food truck festival across town this weekend,” Adora was saying on their last day of classes when they had both

returned home. She and Catra were folding laundry on the coffee table. “Do you want to come with us?”

“Yeah, that sounds-“

An Instagram notification lit up Bow’s phone, catching his eye immediately.

Apparently, the beginning of summer was also bringing Prime back into town, performing a series of shows around the area to promote their new EP.

“Prime is back in town,” Bow said numbly.

“Oh,” Adora said. “Well, I guess they already extended the tour once, they had to come home sometime.”

Home.

“They’re playing at The Wheel tonight,” Bow said. “Do we want to go?”

Catra took a terse sip of her tea before answering.

“I’m not really on speaking terms with Prime anymore,” Catra said.

“But you should go,” Adora said. “It might be good to see...everybody.”

Bow chewed on the inside of his cheek.

“I’ll think about it,” He said. “It might be fun.”

Against his better judgement, Bow found himself walking to The Wheel that night to see Glimmer- to see Prime- alone. He felt out of place amongst the people who were so excited to be there.

Was he excited to see Glimmer?

He was just there to check on her, just to see that she was okay-

But Glimmer was okay. She had made it perfectly clear that she was fine and happy with her choices, so he had no reason to be there.

Bow stood up and began to leave, and then the music started.

And then she stepped onto the stage, and Bow's heart was all of a sudden entirely too big for his chest.

What had he expected? He knew that he would see her, he knew that seeing her would feel...odd.

But there was something about seeing her, right there onstage, illuminated by the blue and purple glow of the stage lights, that stabbed through him painfully.

She looked beautiful, not like the Glimmer he knew or even like the one who he had said goodbye to six months ago, but she was still so beautiful. Her hair was longer, longer than it had been in years, and curling around her shoulders. And she seemed sharper- maybe it was the crop top made with black mesh, exposing a strip of her stomach over the waistband of her ripped, high-waisted jeans, or maybe it was that her eyeliner was precise enough to cut diamonds, maybe that her darkly painted lips exposed her teeth, bared even while she was singing.

She was singing about not needing to be loved.

As if he hadn't known that.

The set ended. Glimmer bade the shouting crowd goodnight and disappeared offstage.

What was Bow even doing there? What did he expect to happen? That Glimmer was going to see him and realize how much she missed him and-

"I- Bow?"

Bow turned around- Glimmer was walking towards him.

"Were you going to leave without saying hello?" She asked. She looked better and worse up close- he could see even more clearly how much she had changed, but also how she was still remarkably, painfully the same. Her eyes were still so bright.

"It's good to see you," she said.

"You too," he answered. "The set was great."

"You caught the set?" She smiled. "You're too much. Can I get you a drink?"

"I- yeah, sure. Sounds great." He said. Glimmer pushed her way through the crowd around the bar and ordered him something with an umbrella on top.

“I’m so glad you liked the new songs,” Glimmer said. “We’re actually gaining traction now, and JD thinks that, if things keep going this well, we can do another tour at bigger venues. No more clubs for us.”

“That’s amazing,” Bow said. “I’m so proud of you, Glimmer.”

She smiled at him. “You’re the sweetest, you know. How are classes?”

“Classes are fine,” Bow said. After realizing how lame his response was, he went on: “I’m actually rolling right over into their Masters program.”

“Bow, that’s amazing!” Glimmer said, her smile growing. “I’m not surprised, obviously, but still! Amazing!”

“Thanks, Glimmer,” He said. “I think that- is everything okay?”

Glimmer was looking over his shoulder, back towards the stage. “Yeah, I just- I think I need to get back. I’m being summoned.”

“Oh, okay,” Bow said, his heart sinking. He hadn’t realized his heart had lifted in the first place.

"Sorry, duty calls," She said, standing. Before she left, she put her hand over his. "But it's so, so good to see you, Bow. I'm happy you're happy."

Bow nodded his head and forced a smile, watching her leave once again.

I'm happy you're happy.

I'm happy you're happy.

Bow wasn't happy, but it seemed like Glimmer was. And somehow, that only hurt all the more.

OoO

"Hi," Glimmer said to JD when she got backstage again. "Sorry, I was catching up with someone,"

"I saw that," JD said. "You didn't have to rush back here, baby. I just wanted to make sure you knew we were getting ready to leave."

"It's okay," Glimmer said. "We were kind of running out of things to say."

“He’s your friend, right? Your old roommate?” JD asked, barely looking up from his guitar case. Glimmer marveled at how it felt to hear someone refer to Bow as “her old roommate.” Just six months ago, he had been the most important person in her life, and now he was just…part of her past.

“Yeah,” She said before the pause got too long.

“Are you going to see him before we leave again?”

Glimmer studied JD for a moment before responding.

“I probably should,” She said softly. JD closed his guitar case and smiled blithely.

“Good,” He said, pecking her cheek. “Let’s go home, baby.”

OoO

Catra was sitting on the sofa when Bow came back to the apartment.

“Hey,” Bow said. “Adora’s not home yet?”

“Not yet, but she should be soon. Where were you?”

“I...I went to a show.” Bow explained. “I went and saw Prime.”

“Oh,” Catra said, nodding her head. “How were they?”

“Really good,” Bow said. “Their songs are...they’re good.”

“How was Glimmer?”

What could Bow say to that? Glimmer was an echo of herself. Glimmer looked older and younger at the same time. Glimmer talked to him like he was a fan, like their last conversation hadn’t happened at all, like she had chosen to leave.

“She looks...good.” Bow finally said. “Different.”

“Tell her I want my jacket back,” Catra said.

“I don’t think I’ll be seeing her again,” Bow said. The last word caught in his throat, and then his eyes began to sting. “I don’t think...”

Bow bowed his head forward and finally released the months of tears he had held back. Something about seeing her tonight had broken the last of his barriers. He dropped to the sofa and covered his face in his hands.

To his surprise, Catra moved to sit beside him and gently rubbed his back in comforting circles.

“Do you want to talk about it?” She asked after a while. Bow shook his head.

“I won’t put you through that,” He said. “And there’s really nothing to say.”

“If you say so,” Catra said, handing him a tissue. “Glimmer doesn’t love JD. You know that, don’t you?”

Bow wiped his eyes. “Maybe. I don’t know what Glimmer loves anymore.”

“I can tell.”

“That’s not- that’s not what matters.” Bow said.

“We both know that it does matter, but again, whatever you say.” Catra said. “Do you want some tea?”

Bow cracked a little smile. “Yeah, that sounds nice.”

OoO

Glimmer’s system was unsettled, and she couldn’t calm it down. She was sure that it had something to do with being back in town after six months, and it definitely had something to do with seeing Bow.

But she had seen him for less than ten minutes twenty four hours ago- why was it still bothering her? She turned over their conversation in her mind while she fiddled with the holes in her jeans backstage. Five minutes to places. Five minutes to singing. Five minutes to mull over her thoughts because nothing was distracting her.

Glimmer felt guilty for leaving Bow, for leaving things the way she had with him. She felt guilty for raising her voice, for all the ugly, angry things she had said to him.

Why had she said those things? Why had she wanted to leave so badly?

If Glimmer was honest with herself, she wasn't sure if she loved being on tour. She didn't love the sleeplessness, she didn't love hearing everyone arguing with JD, and she definitely didn't love when JD would "correct" whatever she was doing onstage or offstage.

But she also knew that right now, she was running. And if she stopped running, she would have to look behind her and see all of the wreckage in her wake.

She would have to see the wreck she had made of herself.

She glanced over at JD hanging out of the stage door, talking to a very pretty girl. She wanted him to sign something- a tee shirt? Last week, someone had asked him to sign a bra.

"What's your name, baby?" He asked her.

"Angie," She told him. "It's short for-"

Glimmer's breath caught in her throat. She knew what Angie was short for.

Angella hadn't been short, she had been almost eight inches taller than Glimmer and almost as tall as Bow.

Then there was that feeling again. Like the wind was being knocked out of her. Like someone was squeezing her heart and lungs at the same time.

And it wouldn’t leave. It wouldn’t go away, she was forced to sit with her discomfort, her regret, her unbearable pain.

Glimmer started crying, and once she started crying, she couldn't stop. It took a moment for JD to realize that she was crying, and another moment for him to walk over to her.

“Uh, Glimmer?” He asked, raising an eyebrow. “You okay?”

Glimmer glared at him through her tears.

“No, I’m not!” She told him, crossing her arms.

“I- okay, well, ask a silly question,” JD admitted. He put his hands on her shoulders. “Sweetie, you know the show is about to start, right?”

Glimmer looked at him, incredulous. How could he think about the show at a time like this?

“I do know, actually.” She answered. “I can't go on right now, I-“

“We're already starting late," JD reminded her. “We need the momentum for the EP, we need to do this performance. It’s okay, you can fix your makeup between sets-“

“That’s not why I’m upset!” She almost yelled. “Why does that matter to you, but not the fact that I’m crying? Why don’t you care?”

“Glimmer, obviously I don’t like that you’re crying. But we have to go out and perform, we have a job to do.”

Glimmer looked up at JD for a long moment, taking in everything about him. His long, blonde curls and his lined forehead. His icy blue eyes and hollow cheeks, the soft pout of his lips. He had worked so hard for this moment, for his last show of his tour for his band.

But he didn’t care about her. He never had.

“Two hours,” She said finally. “You get two more hours of me, and then I never want to see you again.”

“What?” JD asked. “Glimmer, what’s going-“

“Let’s get onstage,” She said shortly. “We have a job to do.”

OoO

Bow was the only one awake when someone knocked on the apartment door later that night. He looked over at his alarm clock- it was midnight. Maybe Adora had left her keys and Catra didn't have her lock pick handy.

Glimmer was on the other side of the door, her phone and keys clenched in her trembling hand.

"Hi," She said softly.

"Hi," Bow said back.

"Can I come inside?"

"I- what- of course you can come inside," He told her. "Here, I'm sorry it's kind of a mess in here."

Glimmer walked past him and into the living room without another word. Bow watched her stand there for a moment before he started talking against.

“What’s up? Are you okay?”

“I quit the band,” she said softly.

“You- what? Glimmer, why?”

“Because JD is a dick,” She said, her voice small.

“Well, I knew that," He said. “I thought you knew that, too.”

“And…because you were right,” She admitted. “Because I didn’t like the person I was when I was with them, but I kept running away because if I didn’t have to be me, I didn’t have to…”

She covered her face in her hands. Bow swallowed, trying to ease the lump that was forming in his throat. He shouldn’t feel as conflicted as he felt now- Glimmer had made a decision that she regretted now. He knew that she wouldn’t like her decisions eventually, and here she was, standing in front of him, realizing that he was right. After six months of complete silence, after leaving without a backwards glance, she was standing in his living room, in the home they used to share.

“I just want her back, Bow!” She wailed through her tears and her hands. “I want my mom!”

All the anger and resentment and confusion that Bow felt for Glimmer stopped mattering. He all but ran to her side and took her into his arms, the way he had wanted to since he first saw her days ago, the way he used to when she cried.

In that instant, Glimmer was five again, crying because she had lost her dad. She was thirteen again, crying because no one wanted to be her lab partner. She was twenty again, crying because her mom was gone. She was every version of herself that Bow had known and loved, and she needed him.

And damn it all, he couldn't keep himself from loving *this* Glimmer. As hard as he had tried to forget her, his heart was still full of love for her.

"It's alright," he said softly, gently rocking her back and forth. "It's okay. I'm here."

"I'm so sorry, Bow," she sobbed. "I should have listened to you, I'm so sorry, I'm so sorry…"

"Don't worry about that now," he said.

"I want to come home," she said.

Bow's heart swelled- he knew exactly what Glimmer meant. He was her home, and she wanted to come home to him.

“Alright,” he said. “Come home, then.”

“Are you sure?” She asked.

“Always,” he answered.

“Are you still mad at me?”

Bow furrowed his brow.

“Much less so now,” he said. As glad as he was to have Glimmer back, he couldn’t ignore the nagging in the back of his head, telling him what he had to say.

“I- Glimmer, I need you to do something for me.”

“Okay?”

“I want you to start seeing someone.” He said. “Like...like a professional.”

“Like a therapist?”

“Yes.”

“I- why?”

“Because you’re still hurting, and you need guidance through that that I’m just not capable of giving you.”

“What are you-“ Glimmer distanced herself from him so she could look up at his face.

“I’m not saying that I won’t be there for you. You can always talk to me about anything, and I’ll always be there for you in whatever way I can. I just think that it would be good for you to talk to a professional, and not just me.”

Bow put his hands on Glimmer’s shoulders.

“I lost you once, Glimmer,” He said. “And I’m worried that unless we get you some help, I’ll lose you again. And I don’t want to do that a second time. It would break my heart.”

Glimmer considered his words for a second, then nodded her head.

“Okay,” She agreed. “I’ll call someone tomorrow.”

Bow breathed a sigh of relief. “Okay. Thank you.”

“You really do want me to get better,” Glimmer said.

“Of course I do,” He said, wiping a stray tear off of her cheek. “That’s all I’ve wanted for you, Glimmer.”

“Thank you for caring about me,” She said, leaning her head against his hand.

“Of course I care about you,” He said. “That’s nothing to praise me for.”

“You’d be surprised,” Glimmer sighed, then asked: “Are we ever going to be like we were again?”

Glimmer raised her gaze from his chest up to his eyes, her eyes rimmed with red and her cheeks flushed. Somehow, she was still the most beautiful thing in Bow’s world.

“Do you want us to be?” He asked.

Glimmer stood on her tiptoes, she was very nearly at eye-level with him now.

"Maybe we can make one tiny change?"

"What's that?" He asked, his voice barely above a whisper.

Glimmer leaned in- he could feel her wet eyelashes fluttering against his cheek- and pressed a soft, perfect kiss onto his lips. Before she could pull away, Bow wrapped his arms tighter around her waist and pulled her closer to him, keeping her mouth on his. No matter what happened, Bow would do everything in his power to keep Glimmer in his arms, he would hold her so tightly and love her so fiercely that she would never want to run away again.

And if she did, he would run with her.

"I think I can manage that," he said when they finally resurfaced. Glimmer smiled, her lips still only a few inches from his.

"I missed you," she said.

"I missed you even more."

“Can you ever forgive me?”

“Don’t worry about that,” he said. “You made your way home, and that’s what matters.”

“You’re what matters,” she said. “You’ve always been what matters- and I’m sorry it took me so long to see it.”

“You came around in the end.” He reminded her, pulling her close again.

She yawned.

“Let’s go to bed, Glimmer,” Bow said gently. Glimmer nodded her head, then gripped the front of his shirt.

“Will you stay with me?” She asked. Bow pressed a kiss to the top of her head.

“Of course I’ll stay with you.”

Chapter End Notes

WOOOOO HI GUYS

Do you ever accidentally forget that fanfic exists for a year, then bang out a few thousand words in the span of a week?

Because that’s where I am right now. If you couldn’t tell. I’m being very subtle about it.

Anyway, I hope you all enjoyed this lil chapter, there will probably be one more before we put this baby to bed. Please please please leave comments and kudos if you feel so moved.

Love and some verses,
Somebody’s Muse

Chapter 4

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Rays of golden sunlight were streaming in through the windows when Glimmer woke up, cocooned in Bow's embrace. She took a deep, relieved breath and snuggled closer, tucking her head beneath his chin.

"Good morning, Glimmer," He said sleepily.

"Go back to sleep," She told him. "It's barely morning."

"Really?" Bow asked, propping himself up to look out the window. "Huh...interesting."

"What's interesting?" Glimmer asked, propping herself up, as well.

"You slept through the night."

Glimmer thought for a moment- she couldn't remember waking up at all last night. She remembered going to sleep while Bow was still working next to her, and rolling over to hold onto him when he finally laid down to rest, but that was all.

“I slept through the night,” She said aloud. Bow smiled and gently kissed her.

“I’m so proud of you, sweetheart,” He said softly.

“I went to sleep. Let’s not throw me a ticker tape parade.” Glimmer reminded him, resting her head back on her pillow.

“You know what I meant,” Bow said, laying beside her. Their noses were almost touching. “I’m proud of you for everything. All your progress.”

Glimmer tried not to blush- the last few months had been equally wonderful and terrible. Shopping for a therapist and eventually finding one had been about as stressful as she could have imagined, and the first month of bi-weekly sessions had been emotionally exhausting, like losing her mom all over again. Going back to classes had been a harrowing adjustment, full of pitying glances from her professors and fellow classmates, none of whom expected her to return to school at all, especially considering how successful Prime’s newest releases were.

But every day, Glimmer got to go running with Adora. She got to snark back and forth with Catra. She got to kiss her adoring, supportive, wonderful boyfriend good morning and goodnight and hello and goodbye, and that was the most wonderful thing she had ever done. It felt better than anything had ever hurt.

“You should go back to sleep, honey,” Bow said softly, stroking her cheek with a gentle hand. “Let yourself rest.”

That was one of Bow’s favorite things to say to her because according to her therapist: “Emotional labor is still labor, and you need to rest from it.”

Glimmer rested her head on his chest and snuggled towards him, he wrapped his arms around her and pulled her close. This was the safest place in the world for her.

It was moments like these when she felt three words on the tip of her tongue, always waiting to be released for Bow and Bow alone.

“Bow?” She asked.

“Mhmm?” He said.

“I love you.”

Bow shifted beside her, Glimmer could tell he was looking down at her again.

“I love you,” She said again. Bow sighed and pulled her closer, pressing a kiss to her forehead.

“I love you too,” He told her.

“Mmmm,” Glimmer said. “Thank goodness.”

Bow kissed her head again.

“Go to sleep, sweetheart.” He told her. “I’ll be here when you wake up.”

They slept.

Chapter End Notes

Hello, sweet friends.

Here is the final chapter of this little fic- thank you for reading and for all of your kind words. As always, please leave kudos and comments if you feel so moved.

Love,
Somebody’s Muse

End Notes

HI GUYS LONG TIME NO SEE!

I have decided, once again, to make Glimbow my entire personality, and I have made it all of y'all's problem in the process.

Speaking of, does anyone else love Bon Iver? I LOVE Bon Iver. I'm starting to think that maybe Bow doesn't, though.

ANYWAY, as always, please leave comments and kudos if you feel so moved. I wonder if these crazy kids will make it work this time?

Obviously I'll update soon. You cannot keep me from writing more and YES that is a threat.

Love and some verses,
Somebody's Muse

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!